

UI/UX & Frontend Design Guideline

Urban Furniture — Accounting System

Version: 1.0 **Document Type:** UI/UX Development & Frontend Design Guideline **Companion Document:** Urban Furniture Accounting System — PRD v1.1

Table of Contents

1. Design Brief & Approach
 2. Design Tokens (Color, Type, Layout, Principles)
 3. Information Architecture (Site Map)
 4. Navigation Structure
 5. Page-by-Page Specifications
 6. Core UI Components
 7. States: Empty, Loading, Error, Success
 8. Responsive Behavior
 9. Accessibility Guidelines
 10. Interaction & Motion Guidelines
 11. Design QA Checklist
-

1. Design Brief & Approach

1.1 Who this is for

This system is used by a small furniture business's **Owner** and **Accountant** — not professional accountants, and not designers. It is also used by **Customers/Vendors** who only ever see a small, restricted slice of it (their own invoices/bills).

1.2 What the design needs to do

- Make double-entry accounting feel **effortless**, even though the underlying logic (debit/credit, ledgers) is precise and unforgiving.
- Present **dense financial data** (tables of transactions, ledgers, reports) in a way that is scannable, not overwhelming.
- Clearly separate the three experiences: **Admin/Accountant back office**, **Contact self-service portal**, and **System-generated read-only records** (journal entries should visually read as “generated,” not editable).

1.3 Design personality

Grounded, precise, and quietly warm — like a well-kept paper ledger crossed with the material honesty of furniture craftsmanship (grain, joinery, straight lines) rather than a generic glossy

SaaS dashboard. Numbers should feel **trustworthy and aligned**; navigation should feel **calm and predictable**, since users will return to the same handful of screens daily.

2. Design Tokens

2.1 Color — “Ledger & Walnut”

Instead of the common AI-generated palettes (cream + terracotta, or near-black + neon accent), this system draws its palette from two real objects in the business’s world: **the paper ledger** and **walnut furniture wood**.

Token	Hex	Role
--paper	#FAF8F4	Base background — warm off-white, like ledger paper (not stark white, not the common #F4F1EA)
--ink	#22201C	Primary text — warm near-black, like fountain-pen ink on paper
--walnut	#7A4B32	Primary accent — buttons, active nav state, links (evokes furniture wood, not the common terracotta #D97757)
--ledger-green	#2F4B3C	Secondary accent — used only for positive financial values (credits, profit, paid status)
--rule-red	#8C3B2E	Used only for negative financial values (debits shown as outflow, overdue, unpaid) — a muted brick red, not alarm red
--line	#DEDAD1	Borders, table rules, dividers — warm grey, not cold #E5E5E5
--surface	#FFFFFF	Card/table surfaces sitting on --paper

Rule: Green and red are **reserved exclusively for financial polarity** (money in vs. money out, profit vs. loss) — never used decoratively elsewhere in the UI. This keeps color meaningful: the moment a number turns red, the user knows it means something specific.

2.2 Typography — “Ledger Numerals”

Role	Typeface	Notes
UI text (labels, nav, body)	IBM Plex Sans	Humanist, quietly professional, not the default Inter/Helvetica
Financial figures & table data	IBM Plex Mono	Tabular numerals align perfectly in columns — critical for scanning debit/credit columns and reports, and ties visually to the idea of a typewritten ledger
Headings	IBM Plex Sans, Medium/SemiBold weight	Same family as body — one typeface family used deliberately across two roles rather than mixing in a display serif

Type scale: | Level | Size / Line-height | Weight | Use | |—|—|—|—| | H1 | 28px / 36px | SemiBold | Page titles (“Purchase Orders”) | | H2 | 20px / 28px | SemiBold | Section headers within a page | | H3 | 16px / 24px | Medium | Card/table group headers | | Body | 14px / 20px | Regular | Default UI text | | Small / Caption | 12px / 16px | Regular | Helper text, timestamps, field hints | | Figures (mono) | 14px / 20px | Regular/Medium | All currency values, quantities, account balances |

Line length for any paragraph content (help text, empty-state copy) capped at ~70 characters.

2.3 Layout Concept

Alignment: Left-aligned throughout. Financial software is scanned top-to-bottom, left-to-right — centered layouts slow this down. Numeric columns (amounts, debit, credit) are **right-aligned** within tables, as in a real ledger, so digits stack for easy comparison.

Structure: Persistent left sidebar (module navigation) + top bar (context: current company, current user/role, date) + main content area. This is a deliberate choice for a **daily-use back-office tool** (unlike a marketing site) — users need constant access to switch between Contacts, Purchases, Sales, and Reports without losing their place.

+-----+-----+-----+-----+			
[Logo]	Urban Furniture	[Role: Accountant] [@]	<- Top bar
+-----+-----+-----+-----+			
Dashboard	MAIN CONTENT AREA		
Contacts			
Products			
Chart of			
Accounts			
Journals			

Purchases		
Sales		
Payments		
Reports		

Density: Compact by default (8px/12px vertical rhythm in tables) — this is a data tool, not a marketing page. Whitespace is used to separate *sections*, not to pad every row.

2.4 Principles

1. **Numbers are the hero, not chrome.** Every screen's job is to get a number (a balance, a total, a due amount) in front of the user accurately and fast.
2. **Green/red mean something specific** — financial polarity only, never decorative.
3. **The System's voice is separate from the user's.** Auto-generated Journal Entries are visually marked read-only (locked icon, muted background) so users never confuse "things I did" with "things the system computed for me."
4. **One accent, used sparingly.** Walnut brown is the only saturated color used for interactive elements (buttons, links, active states) — everything else stays in the ink/paper/line neutral range.
5. **No decorative motion.** Only functional transitions (expanding a row, confirming a save) — never entrance animations on page load.

3. Information Architecture (Site Map)

Login

|-- (role-based redirect)

Admin / Accountant Workspace

```

|-- Dashboard
|-- Contacts
|   |-- Contacts List
|   |-- Contact Form (Create/Edit)
|-- Products
|   |-- Products List
|   |-- Product Form (Create/Edit)
|-- Chart of Accounts
|   |-- CoA List
|   |-- CoA Form (Create/Edit)
|-- Journals
|   |-- Journals List
|   |-- Journal Form (Create/Edit)
|   |-- Journal Entries (read-only ledger view)
|-- Purchases
|   |-- Purchase Orders List
|   |-- Purchase Order Detail/Form
|   |-- Vendor Bills List
|   |-- Vendor Bill Detail (+ Register Payment)
|-- Sales
```

```
|      |-- Sales Orders List
|      |-- Sales Order Detail/Form
|      |-- Customer Invoices List
|      +-- Customer Invoice Detail (+ Register Payment)
|-- Payments
|      +-- Payments List (all payments, cross-reference)
|-- Reports
|      |-- Balance Sheet
|      |-- Profit & Loss
|      +-- Budget Report (stretch goal)
+-- Settings (Admin only)
|      +-- Users & Roles (stretch goal)
```

Contact Portal (Customer / Vendor)

```
|-- My Invoices/Bills List
|-- Invoice/Bill Detail
+-- Make Payment
```

Shared

```
|-- 403 -- Permission Denied
|-- 404 -- Not Found
+-- Empty States (per module)
```

4. Navigation Structure

4.1 Sidebar (Admin/Accountant)

Fixed left sidebar, icon + label, grouped in this order (matches the natural workflow: set up data, then transact, then get paid, then report): 1. Dashboard 2. Contacts 3. Products 4. Chart of Accounts 5. Journals (*includes Journal Entries sub-view*) 6. Purchases 7. Sales 8. Payments 9. Reports 10. Settings (*bottom of list, visually separated — Admin only*)

Active module is indicated by a **filled walnut-brown left border + bold label** — not a filled background block (keeps sidebar quiet).

4.2 Top Bar

- Left: Company name/logo (static for MVP — single company)
- Right: Current logged-in user name + role badge, logout

4.3 Contact Portal Navigation

Minimal top bar only (no sidebar) — Contacts only ever need two destinations: **My Invoices/Bills** and their **Profile**. A simplified nav reinforces that this is a restricted, lightweight view, distinct from the internal back office.

4.4 Breadcrumbs

Used on all Detail/Form pages: Purchases > Purchase Orders > P0-1042. This matters because many records are reached two ways (directly from a list, or drilled into from a related record — e.g., a Payment reached from a Vendor Bill) and the breadcrumb keeps orientation clear.

5. Page-by-Page Specifications

5.1 Login Page

Purpose: Authenticate and route to the correct workspace (Admin/Accountant back office vs. Contact portal). **Components:** Logo, email field, password field, “Sign in” button, error message area. **Layout:** Centered single-column card, max-width 380px, on - -paper background. No sidebar. **States:** - *Error:* Inline message under the password field — “That email or password isn’t right.” (never vague, never blames the user) - *Loading:* Button shows a spinner and disables itself, label stays “Signing in...”

5.2 Dashboard

Purpose: At-a-glance snapshot for Admin/Accountant — cash position, outstanding money, recent activity. **Components:** - KPI row: Cash + Bank Balance, Total Debtors (money owed to you), Total Creditors (money you owe), Net Profit (this period) - Recent Transactions table (last 10 Journal Entries, read-only, links to source document) - Quick Actions: “New Sales Order,” “New Purchase Order,” “Record Payment”

+-----+				
	Cash+Bank: 1,24,500 Debtors: 32,000 Creditors: 18,400			
	+-----+			
	Net Profit (this month): 41,200			
	+-----+			
	Recent Activity		[New Sale]	[New PO]

	Date	Reference	Account	Debit
	09/03	CustomerInvoice#7	Debtors	5,000
	09/03	CustomerInvoice#7	Sale Income	-
				5,000
	+-----+			

States: - *Empty (new company, no transactions yet):* KPI cards show “-” with caption “No transactions recorded yet.” Quick Actions become the primary visual focus, inviting the first action.

5.3 Contacts List

Purpose: Browse/search all Customers, Vendors, and Both. **Components:** Search bar, filter chips (All / Customer / Vendor / Both), table (Name, Type, Email, Mobile, City), “New Contact” button, archive toggle (show/hide archived). **Layout:** Full-width table, 25 rows per page, sortable by Name. **Empty state:** “No contacts yet. Add your first customer or vendor to get started.” + prominent “New Contact” button.

5.4 Contact Form (Create/Edit)

Purpose: Capture/edit Contact Master fields. **Components:** Name, Type (segmented control: Customer/Vendor/Both), Email, Mobile, Address block (City/State/Pincode), Profile Image upload, Save/Cancel, (Edit mode only) Archive action. **Layout:** Single-column form, max-width 560px, grouped into “Basic Info” and “Address” sections. **Validation:** Required-field errors appear inline below the field on blur, not only on submit.

5.5 Products List

Purpose: Browse/search Product Master. **Components:** Search bar, filter chips (Goods/Service/Combo), table (Name, Type, Category, Sales Price, Cost), “New Product” button. **Layout:** Same table pattern as Contacts List, for consistency.

5.6 Product Form (Create/Edit)

Components: Product Name, Type (segmented control), Category, Sales Price, Cost (Purchase Price), Save/Cancel. **Layout:** Single-column form, max-width 480px. Sales Price and Cost shown side-by-side to invite an at-a-glance margin comparison.

5.7 Chart of Accounts List

Purpose: View the ledger account structure, grouped by type. **Components:** Table grouped under collapsible headers: Assets, Liabilities, Income, Expenses, Capital. Each row: Account Name, running Balance (mono figures, right-aligned). **Note:** This page is mostly **read-heavy** — editing/adding accounts is a rarer action, so “New Account” is a secondary (outline) button, not the primary visual element.

5.8 Journals List & Journal Entries (Ledger View)

Purpose: Journals List lets Admin configure journal types; Journal Entries is the **read-only, system-generated ledger**. **Journal Entries table columns:** Date, Journal, Reference (links to source PO/Bill/SO/Invoice/Payment), Account, Debit, Credit. **Visual treatment:** Rows have a subtle locked-icon and slightly muted background — signaling “the system wrote this, you didn’t.” Clicking a Reference navigates to the source document, reinforcing traceability.

5.9 Purchase Orders List -> Purchase Order Detail

List columns: PO #, Vendor, Date, Status (Draft/Confirmed/Billed/Cancelled — shown as a status pill), Total. **Detail/Form components:** Vendor selector, line items table (Product, Quantity, Unit Price, Line Total), Order Total, action buttons contextual to status: - *Draft*:

“Confirm Order” - *Confirmed*: “Convert to Vendor Bill” - *Billed*: Read-only, link to the resulting Vendor Bill

5.10 Vendor Bills List -> Vendor Bill Detail

List columns: Bill #, Vendor, Invoice Date, Due Date, Payment Status pill (Unpaid/Partially Paid/Paid — red/amber/green), Total. **Detail components:** Bill summary, linked Purchase Order reference, **Register Payment** panel (Amount, Method: Cash/Bank, Pay button), Payment history table beneath. **Rule enforced in UI:** Payment amount field cannot exceed the outstanding balance — shown as a live helper text (“Max: 4,200”) rather than only failing after submit.

5.11 Sales Orders List -> Sales Order Detail

Mirrors the Purchase Order pattern exactly (same list/detail structure), but with Customer, Tax column added to line items, and “Convert to Customer Invoice” as the terminal action. Consistency here is deliberate — Purchases and Sales are structurally identical flows, so reusing the same layout reduces the learning curve for users switching between them.

5.12 Customer Invoices List -> Customer Invoice Detail

Mirrors the Vendor Bill pattern exactly, including the same Payment Status pill colors and Register Payment panel.

5.13 Payments List

Purpose: Cross-cutting view of all payments (both directions) for reconciliation. **Components:** Table — Date, Direction (In/Out, shown via green/red icon), Contact, Linked Document (Bill/Invoice), Amount, Method. **Filter:** By date range, by method (Cash/Bank), by direction.

5.14 Reports — Balance Sheet

Purpose: Real-time Assets = Liabilities + Capital snapshot. **Layout:** Two-column layout — Assets on the left, Liabilities + Capital stacked on the right, each account listed with its balance (mono, right-aligned), subtotals bolded, grand totals in a bordered footer row that visually confirms the two sides match. **Controls:** “As of” date picker at top. **Note:** If totals do not match (should never happen if the engine is correct, but worth designing for), show a visible warning banner rather than silently displaying mismatched numbers — this is a financial tool, so silent errors are unacceptable.

5.15 Reports — Profit & Loss

Layout: Single column — Income accounts listed with amounts, subtotal; Expense accounts listed with amounts, subtotal; Net Profit as a bordered summary row at the bottom (green if positive, red if negative — the one place a whole row uses polarity color). **Controls:** Date range picker (Period Start / Period End).

5.16 Reports — Budget Report (Stretch Goal)

Layout: Table grouped by Analytic Account — Planned Amount, Actual Amount, Variance (colored by polarity), with a simple horizontal bar per row visualizing Actual vs. Planned.

5.17 Contact Portal — My Invoices/Bills List

Purpose: A Contact’s restricted view of only their own documents. **Components:** Tab or filter: Invoices (if Customer) / Bills (if Vendor) / Both. Table: Reference, Date, Due Date, Status pill, Total, “Pay” button (if unpaid/partially paid). **Tone:** Visually lighter/simpler than the internal back office — no sidebar, no financial jargon like “Debtors/Creditors,” just “Amount Due.”

5.18 Contact Portal — Invoice/Bill Detail + Pay

Components: Document summary (line items, total, amount already paid, amount due), “Make Payment” form (Amount, Method), confirmation state after payment. **States:** *Success* — a clear confirmation panel: “Payment received. Your remaining balance is Rs. 0.” (states the outcome plainly, in the interface’s voice.)

5.19 Permission Denied (403) & Not Found (404)

403 copy: “You don’t have access to this page.” + a link back to the user’s home (Dashboard or My Invoices). **404 copy:** “That page doesn’t exist.” + a link back to the user’s home. Both use the same centered, minimal layout as Login — no sidebar, since the user may have landed here from a broken/unauthorized link.

6. Core UI Components

6.1 Buttons

Variant	Use	Style
Primary	One per screen — the main action (“Save,” “Confirm Order,” “Pay”)	Solid - -walnut fill, white text
Secondary	Supporting actions (“Cancel,” “New Account”)	Outline, - -walnut text/border
Destructive	Archive/Cancel-order actions	Outline, - -rule-red text/border — never solid red, to avoid alarming users for a reversible action

6.2 Status Pills

Small, rounded-rectangle, low-saturation fill + solid text color (not solid saturated fill — keeps tables calm): - **Paid / Confirmed:** - - ledger-green text on pale green background -

Unpaid / Draft: - - ink text on - -line background (neutral, not alarming — a draft isn’t a problem) - **Overdue / Partially Paid:** - - rule-red text on pale red background

6.3 Tables

- Header row: small caps avoided (per writing guidance — no unnecessary ALL CAPS labels); use regular-case column labels in Medium weight.
- Numeric columns: right-aligned, IBM Plex Mono.
- Row height: 40px, with a - - line colored 1px bottom border (hairline rule, not a heavy grid).
- Zebra striping: **not used** — instead, hover state highlights the row subtly, keeping the resting table calm and paper-like.

6.4 Forms

- Labels above fields (not floating labels — floating labels hurt scanability for data-entry-heavy forms).
- Required fields marked with a subtle asterisk, not color alone.
- Inline validation on blur, not just on submit.

6.5 Modals

Used sparingly — only for **irreversible or high-consequence confirmations** (e.g., “Archive this contact? Their historical transactions will be preserved.”). Not used for routine forms — those live on their own page/route so they’re bookmarkable and back-button-safe.

7. States: Empty, Loading, Error, Success

State	Guidance
Empty	Every list page’s empty state names the action to take next in plain language (e.g., “No purchase orders yet. Create one to record your first purchase.”) — an invitation to act, not a dead end.
Loading	Skeleton rows matching the table’s real row height (not a centered spinner) so layout doesn’t jump when data arrives.
Error	States what happened and how to fix it, in the system’s voice — never “Oops!” or an apology. E.g., “Payment couldn’t be saved. The amount exceeds the outstanding balance of Rs. 4,200.”
Success	Explicit confirmation using the same verb as the action taken — a “Confirm Order” button leads to a banner reading “Order confirmed,” never a generic “Success!”

8. Responsive Behavior

Breakpoint	Behavior
Desktop (>=1024px)	Full sidebar + content, as specified above. This is the primary target — the back office is a desk-based, daily-use tool.
Tablet (768-1023px)	Sidebar collapses to icons-only (labels on hover/tap); tables scroll horizontally within their container rather than wrapping.
Mobile (<768px)	Sidebar becomes a slide-over drawer (hamburger toggle in top bar). Tables convert to stacked “card” rows (one record per card, label:value pairs) — this applies mainly to the Contact Portal , since Admin/Accountant back-office use is expected primarily on desktop.

9. Accessibility Guidelines

- All interactive elements have a visible keyboard focus ring (2px, - -walnut, offset 2px) — never removed via outline: none without a replacement.
- Color is never the only signal: status pills carry text, not just color; polarity (debit/credit, profit/loss) is reinforced with a +/- prefix on the figure itself, not color alone.
- Minimum contrast ratio of 4.5:1 for all body text against its background (verified against the - -paper/- -ink and - -surface/- -ink pairs).
- All form fields have a programmatically associated <label>, not placeholder-only labeling.
- Tables use proper <th> scope attributes so screen readers announce column headers when navigating cells.

10. Interaction & Motion Guidelines

- **No entrance animations** on page load (no fade-and-slide-up sections) — this is a tool used dozens of times a day; animation delay becomes friction, not delight.
- Motion is reserved for **state changes the user caused**: a row expanding to show journal item detail, a status pill transitioning color after a payment is confirmed, a form panel sliding in for “Register Payment.”
- Transitions run at 150-200ms, ease-out — fast enough to feel responsive, not decorative.

11. Design QA Checklist

Before considering any page “done,” confirm: - [] Only one primary (solid walnut) button is visible on the screen at a time - [] All currency/quantity figures use IBM Plex Mono and are

right-aligned in tables - ☐ Green/red appear only for financial polarity — never used
decoratively elsewhere - ☐ Every list page has a designed empty state with a clear next action -
☐ Every form has inline validation and a disabled/loading state on its submit button - ☐
Keyboard focus is visible on every interactive element - ☐ Journal Entry / ledger views are
visually distinguishable as read-only/system-generated - ☐ Page is usable and legible down to
the relevant breakpoint (desktop-first for back office, mobile-first for Contact Portal)